



Lab: Building a Gantt Chart and Milestone Chart: SOP Update for Inventory Management

Estimated duration: 15 minutes

Learning Objectives

After completing this lab, you will be able to:

- 1. Build a **Gantt Chart** that illustrates task sequencing and timing.
- 2. Create a **Milestone Chart** that summarizes key achievements.
- 3. Demonstrate understanding of how **project visualization tools** improve communication and planning.

Part I: Introduction – The Situation

In this lab, you will create your own **Gantt Chart** and **Milestone Chart** for a short, realistic project. You'll use the provided spreadsheet to plan an **SOP (Standard Operating Procedure) Update** that supports the **Inventory Management Function**. By the end of this activity, you'll have practical experience building both tools—just as a **Project Manager**, **Business Analyst**, or **Department Manager** would in a real organization.

Part II: Scenario – SOP Update for Inventory Management

The **Inventory Management Department** has identified the need to update its **Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs)** to improve **accuracy, efficiency, and compliance**. The project will take place over **four quarters (Q1–Q4)** and includes five main activities:

Activity #	Activity	Description	Duration
1	Review Current SOPs	Gather all existing procedures and identify outdated or redundant steps.	Q1
2	Conduct Process Mapping Workshops	Collaborate with warehouse, purchasing, and operations staff to map current workflows.	Q1-Q2
3	Draft Updated SOPs	Write and circulate updated process documentation for feedback.	Q2-Q3
4	Train Staff on New Procedures	Develop materials and conduct staff training sessions.	Q3
5	Implement and Monitor Compliance	Deploy new SOPs and monitor adherence to ensure consistency.	Q4

Part III: Step 1 – Download the Project Tools Spreadsheet

- 1. Open the spreadsheet titled "[Project Tools and Techniques](#)".
Note: Right-click and open the link in a new tab.
- 2. You'll find tabs for:
 - **Gantt Chart**
 - **Milestone Chart**
- 3. Use the **blank templates** provided in these tabs to complete this lab.

Part IV: Step 2 – Review the Scenario

Read the SOP update scenario carefully. Think about when each activity starts, how long it lasts, and which tasks depend on others.

Tip: Not every activity starts immediately. For example, *drafting SOPs (Activity 3)* depends on completing the *process mapping workshops (Activity 2)*.

Part V: Step 3 – Build Your Charts

Gantt Chart

- Add each of the five activities to the timeline (**Q1–Q4**).
- Use **color coding** to distinguish completed, in-progress, and planned tasks.
- Include a **vertical line** to indicate "today's date."

Milestone Chart

- Identify all major milestones and assume they were **completed as scheduled**.
- It is currently the **end of Q2** — plan milestone coding accordingly.

Part VI: Step 4 – Compare to Solution

Once you've completed your charts, review the [Instructor Solution](#) (right-click and open the link in a new tab) version to compare your sequencing, milestone choices, and layout. Reflect on any differences — there might be more than one "right" way to organize the plan!

Deliverables

- **Completed Gantt Chart tab**
- **Completed Milestone Chart tab**

Author(s)

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